

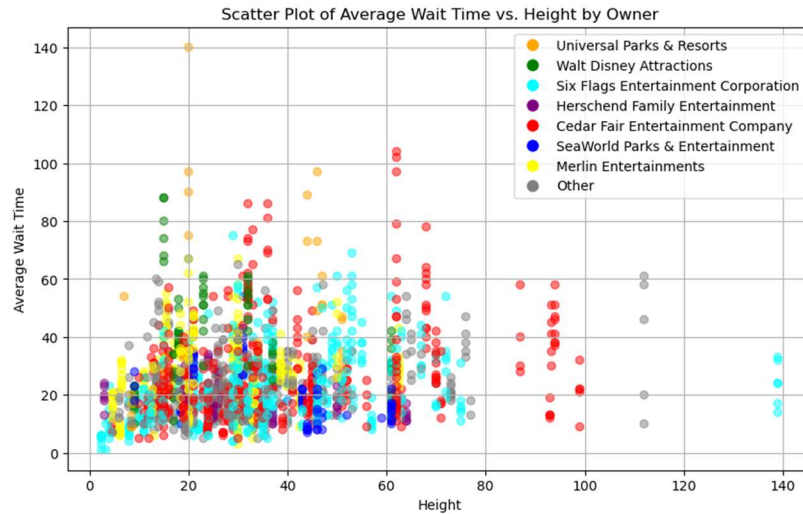
Name: Kyle Salgado-Gouker

Date: November 15, 2023

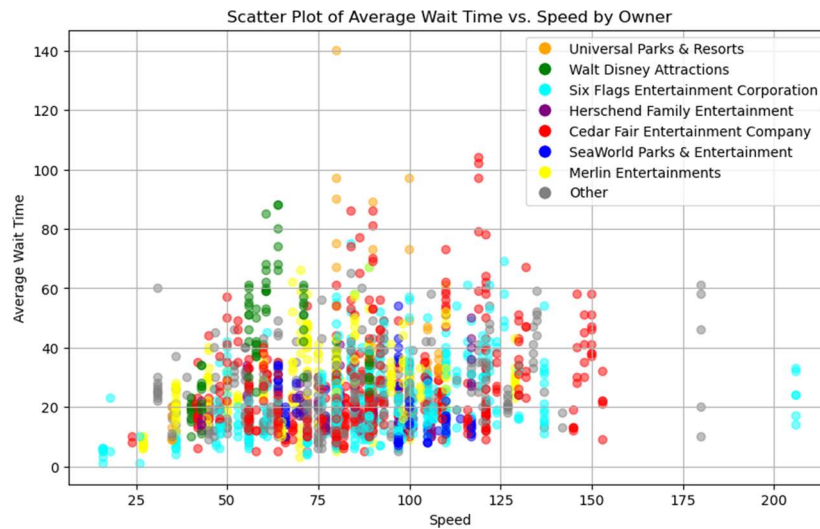
Class: DSC 540 – Professor Williams

Project Milestone #5

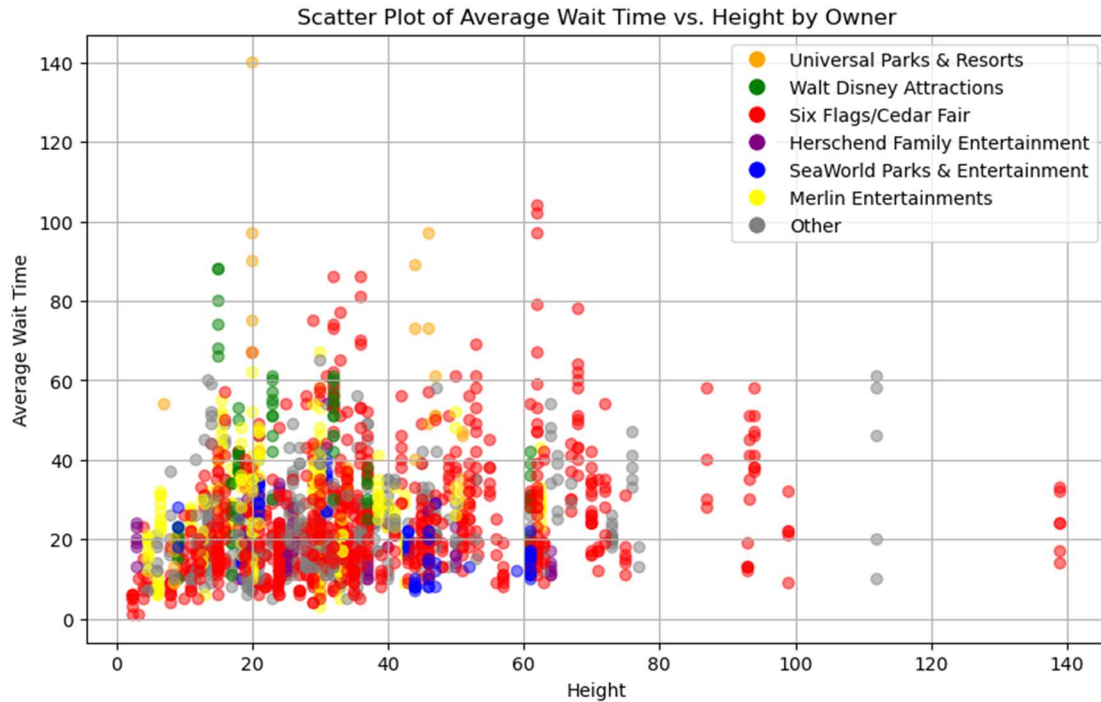
Visualizations for Milestone #5



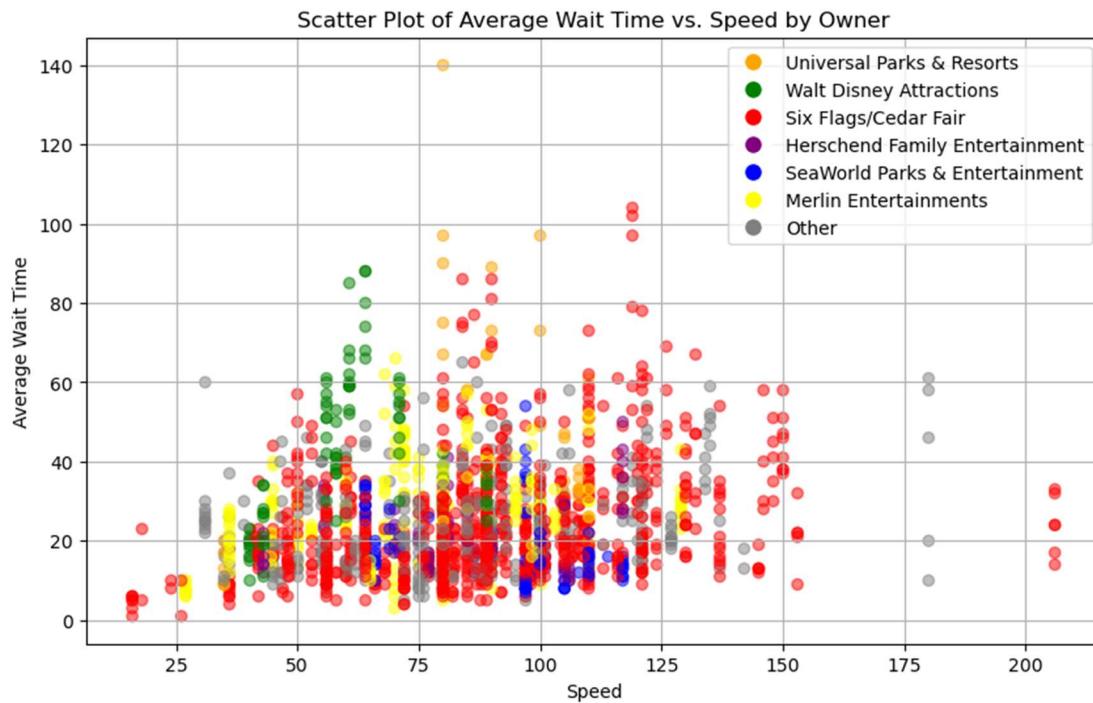
This visualization describes the average wait time (a popularity flux) of coasters vs their height. Additionally, dots are colored depending on which major theme/amusement park company operates them. There is evidence of fervent competition between Six Flags and Cedar Fair.



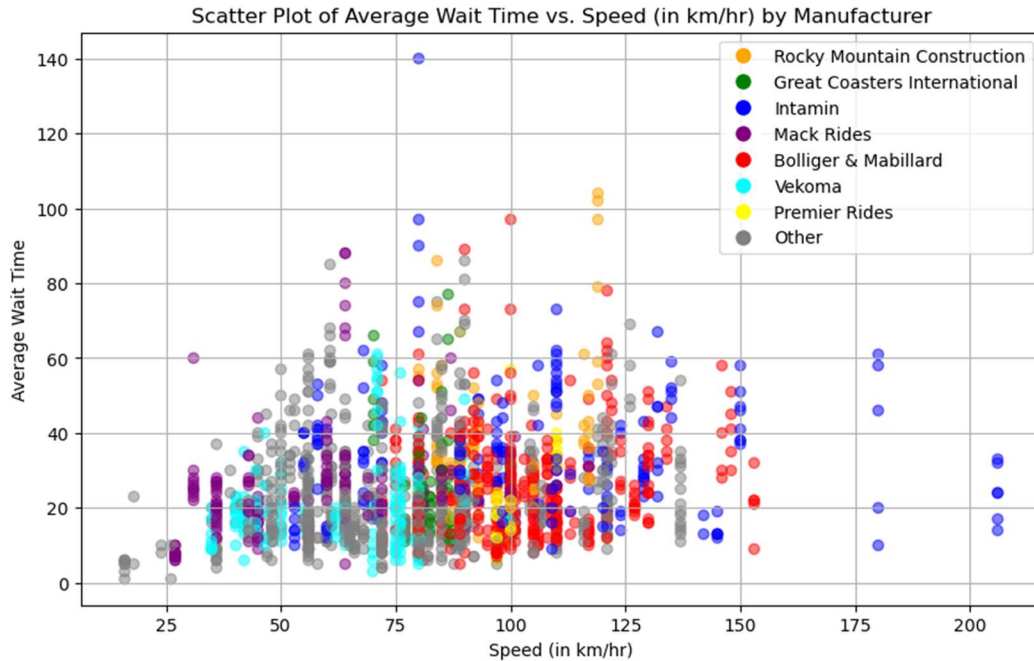
This visualization does the same as above except it is compared to their speed instead of their height. Again, the same leaders (Six Flags and Cedar Fair) are evident.



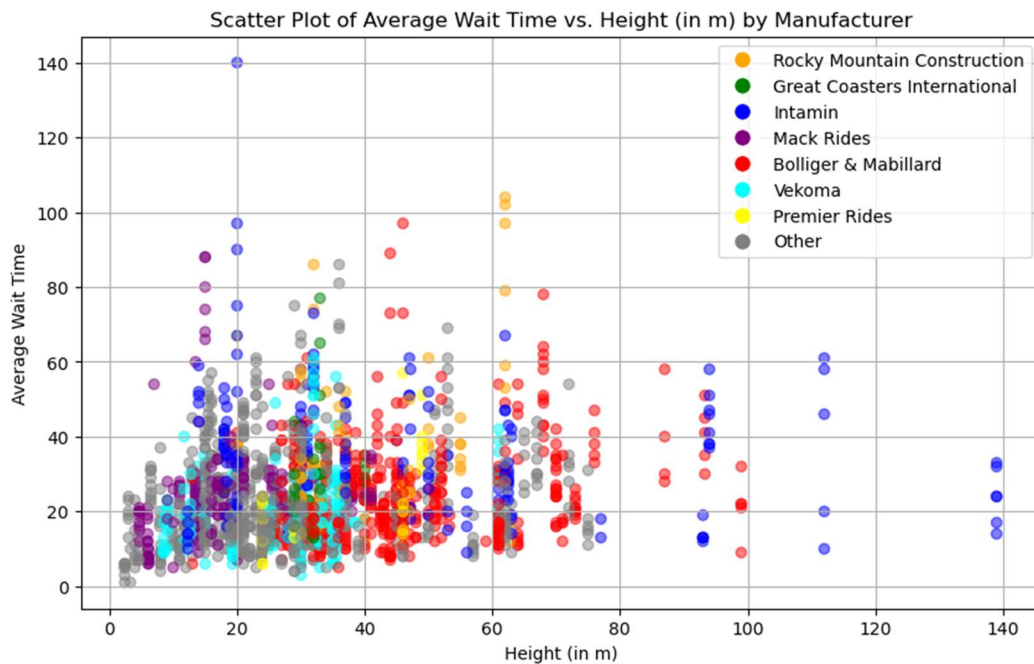
These are the same visualizations, but with Six Flags and Cedar Fair sharing the same colored dot. This is in reference to recent news that the two companies are merging. The Six Flags and Cedar Fair merged entity is dominant in the market for coasters by height.



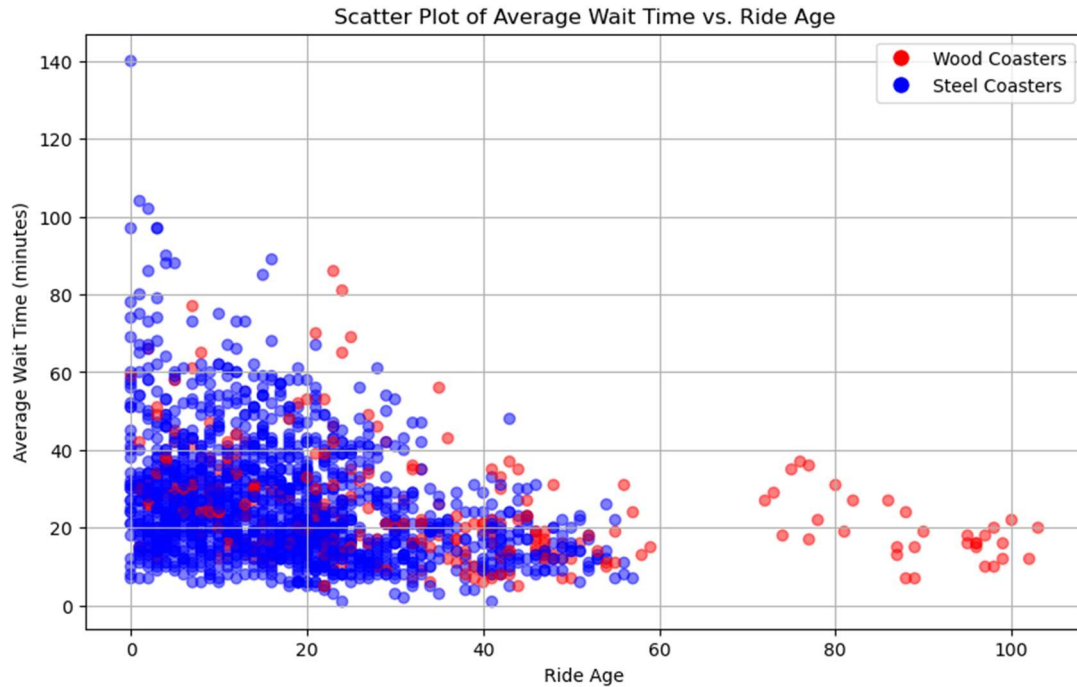
The merger has also made Six Flags/Cedar Fair dominant in the market for coasters by speed.



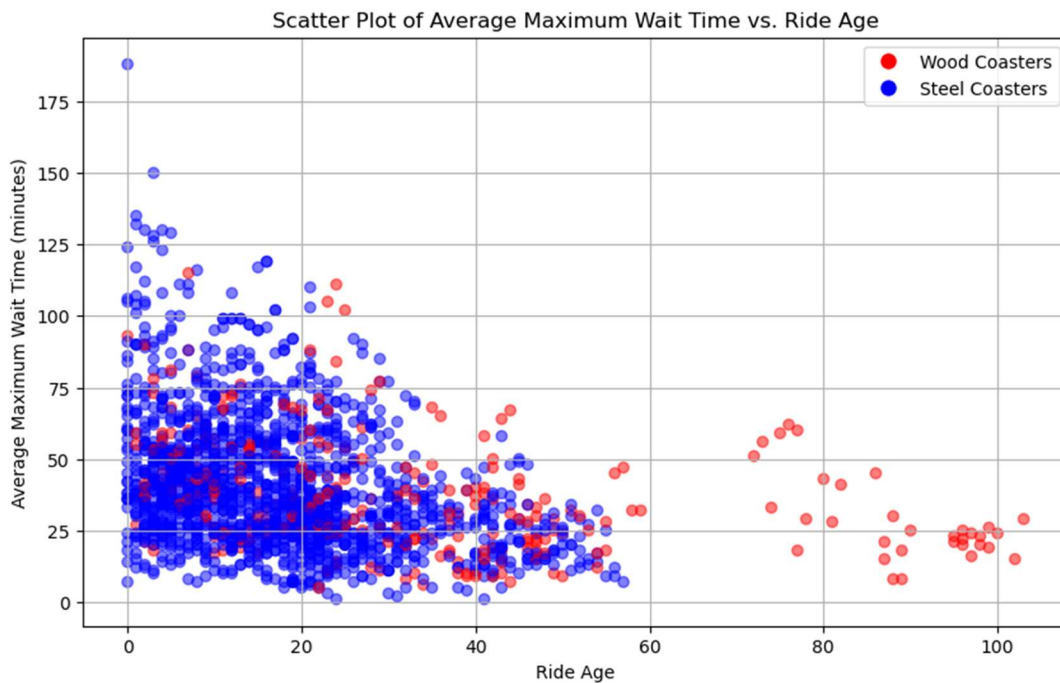
This graph shows average wait time of a ride (as a popularity flux) compared to its speed, this time with the rides' manufacturer in mind.



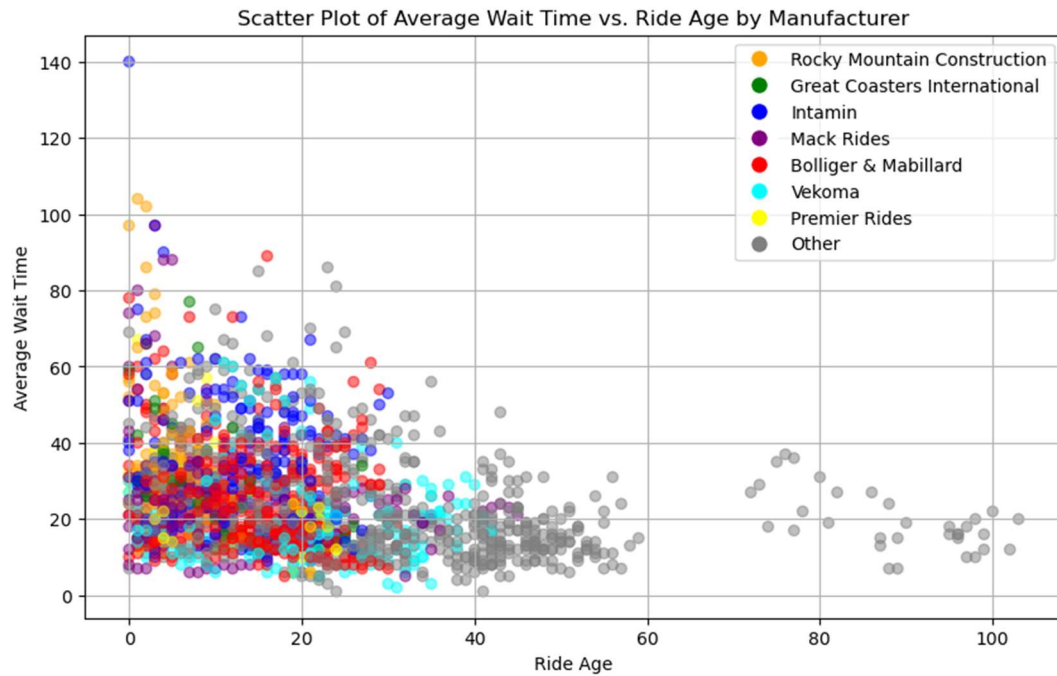
Same visualization but compared to its height instead of speed. The merged Six Flags/Cedar Points entity will not only dominate the consumer market, but also be able to exercise power over its vendors (especially Intamin, Rocky Mountain, and B&M.)



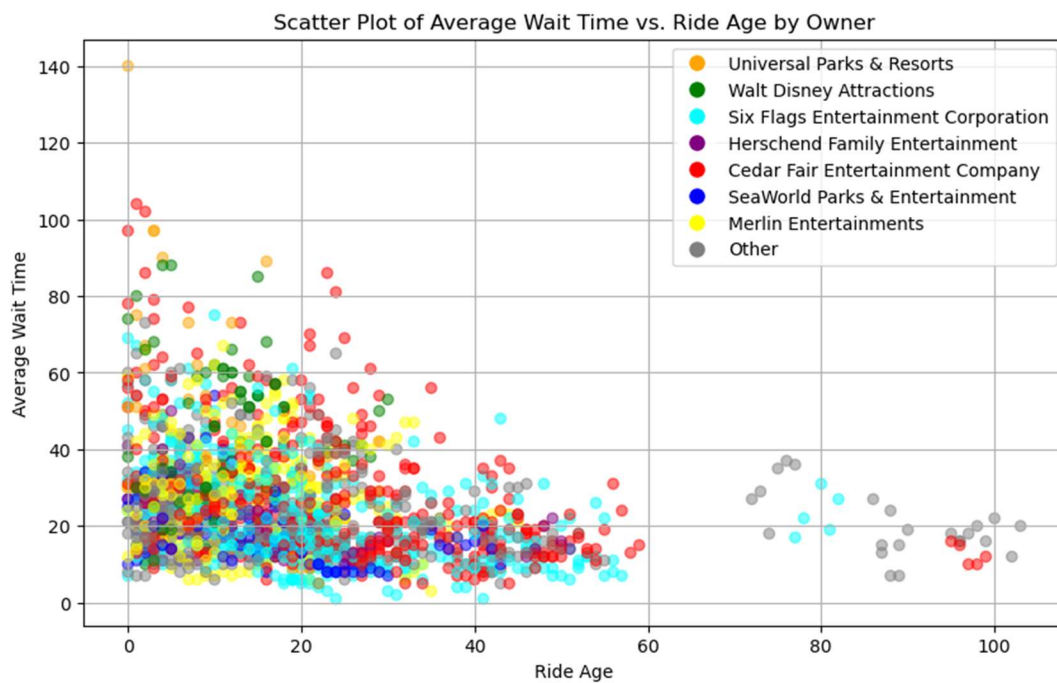
In this visualization, average wait time is compared against the age of a coaster. It shows how the roller coaster market has moved from wood to steel.



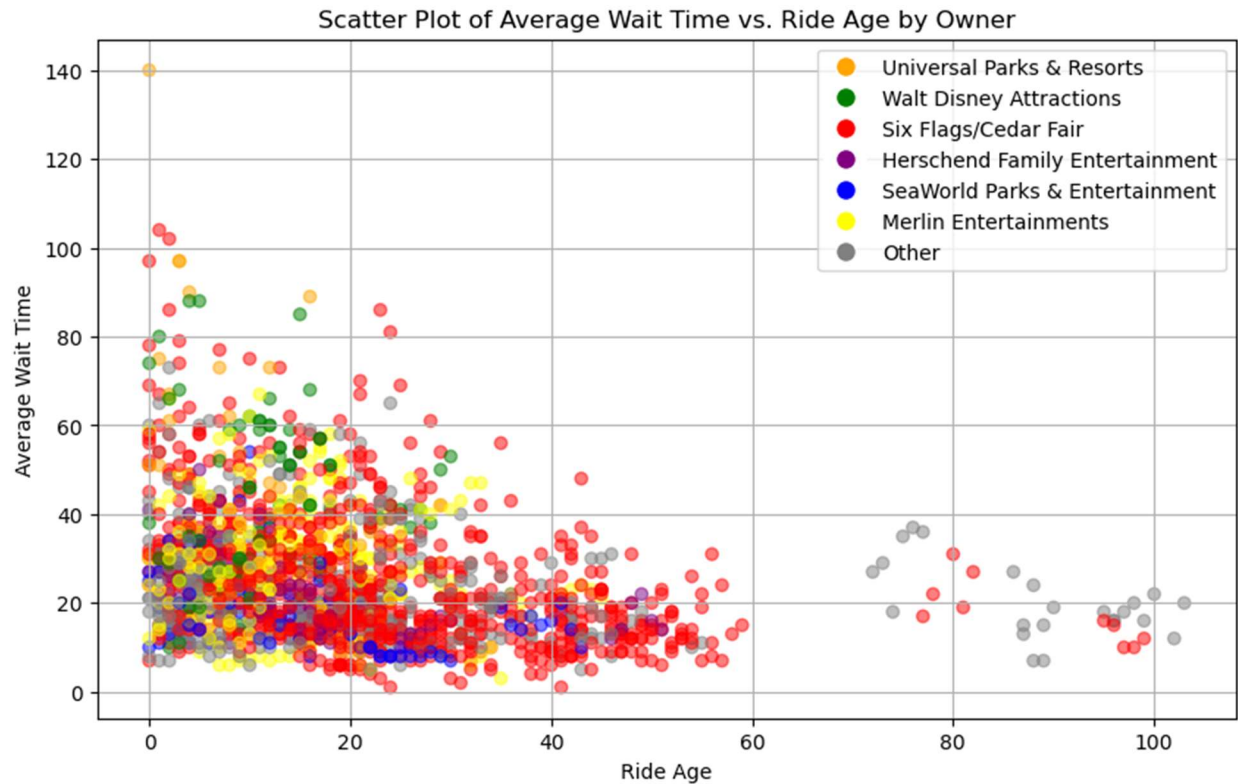
Now for this visualization, the *maximum* average wait time for a coaster is plotted against ride age. This quantity illustrates even more the propensity for customers to seek out thrill rides.



This visualization shows market evolution in terms of manufacturer. Note the recent success of Rocky Mountain Construction!

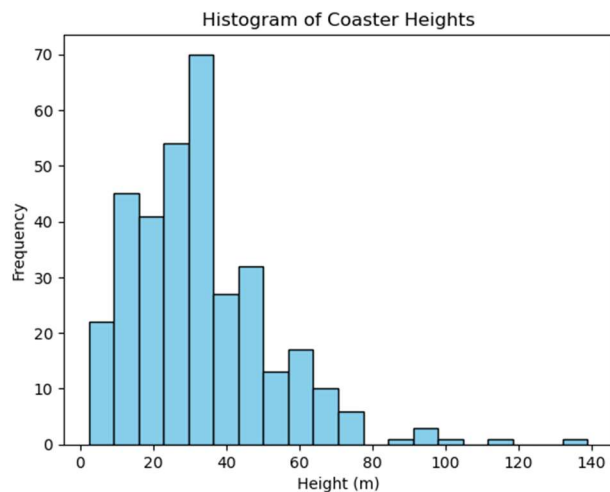


Same visualization, but by park owner illustrates a long competition between Cedar Fair and Six Flags, which will end with the merger.

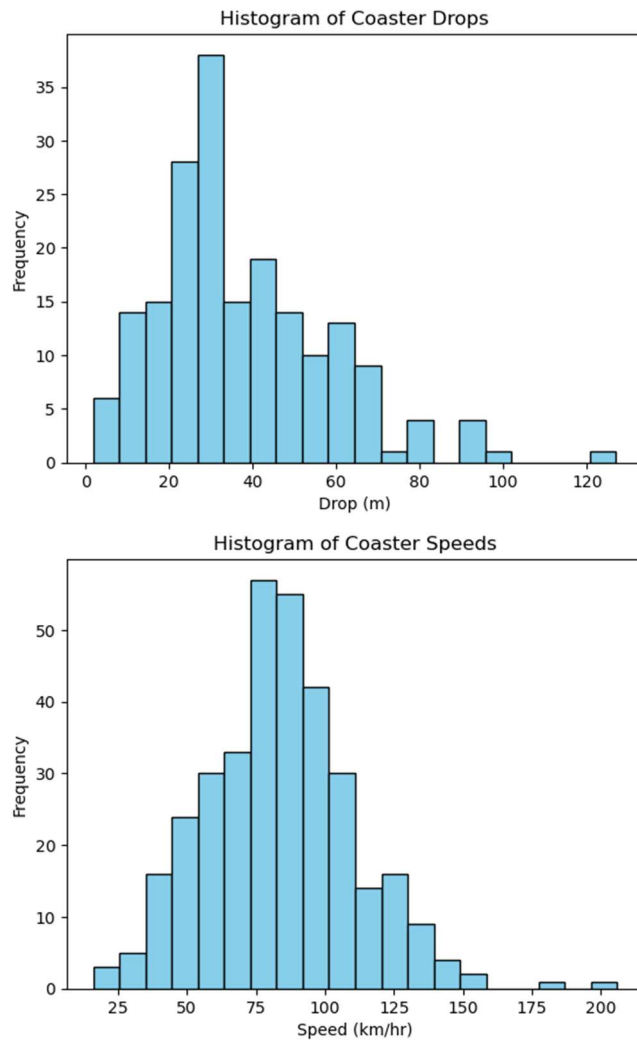


Color coding now post Six Flags/Cedar Fair merger, it is evident that they are the dominant company in the thrill ride market.

The following histograms show how extreme coasters are infrequent and their market is easy to monopolize.



The histogram for coaster drops and coaster speeds confirms the scarcity of extreme rides and the relative ease at establishing a monopoly.



Here is more information about the merger, which is expected to close in the first half of 2024, following receipt of Six Flags shareholder approval, regulatory approvals, and satisfaction of customary closing conditions. :

<https://guidetosfot.com/2023/11/six-flags-cedar-fair-to-merge/>